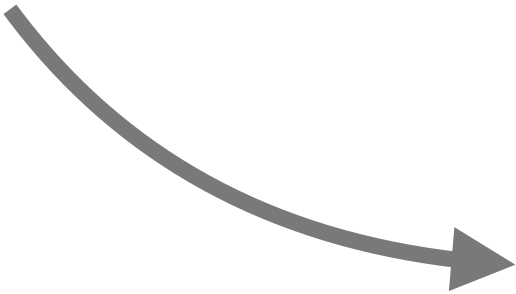


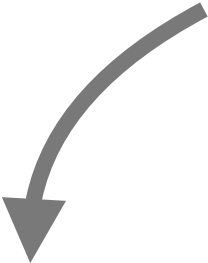
Is this assumption plausible? How might one argue for it?

Here is one kind of argument. Take some contingent thing, like the chair you are sitting on. Can you imagine a world just like this one, but without that chair?

Now pick another contingent thing. Can you subtract that from the world you just imagined?

But, you might think, we can just go on subtracting contingent objects, until there are none left. And then we are imagining a scenario in which there are no contingent things. If that is possible, as it seems to be, then the fact that there are contingent things is itself contingent.





The fact that there are
contingent things is
contingent.

Every contingent fact
has an explanation.

The fact that there
are contingent things
has an explanation.



Leibniz's
argument



the
PSR



objections
to the
PSR



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Here is kind argument. Take something, like the chair you are

Now pick another contingent thing. Can you subtract that from the world you just

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But, you might think, we can just go on subtracting contingent objects, until there

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things is itself continuing.



The fact that there are

containing things is





Every continent has its own

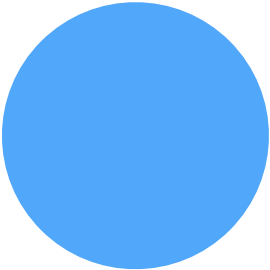
has an expiration.



There is a difference

are continuing things

has an expiration.

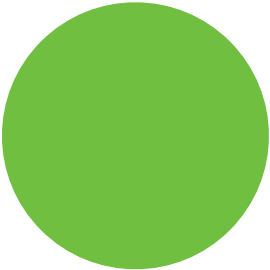


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the
PSR







... we cannot find in any of the individual things, or even in the entire collection and series of things, a sufficient reason for why they exist.

Let us suppose that a book on the elements of geometry has always existed, one copy always made from another. It is obvious that although we can explain a present copy of the book from the previous book from which it was copied, this will never lead us to a complete explanation, no matter how many books back we go, since we can always wonder why there have been such books.

What is true of these books is also true of the different states of the world ... however far back we might go into previous states, we will never find in those states a complete explanation for why there is a world at all, and why it is the way it is.



Leibniz's
argument



objections
to the
PSR

be Good.

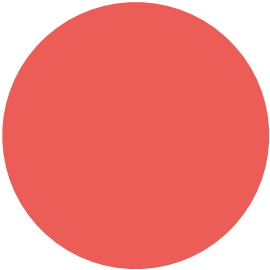
cause exists, then God exists: the objection was that the first cause could

simply be some event, like the Big Bang, which is not a plausible candidate to

Last time we considered an objection to Aquinas' assumption that if a first











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